



BABKA BUNS & RYE BREAD

BAKING WORKSHOP

RECIPE BOOKLET

BREAD
AHEAD
SCHOOL

WELCOME



AN INTRODUCTION FROM MATTHEW

I've been working within the baking industry for more than twenty years now, and I still get a buzz when some fresh bread comes out of the oven or I find a great new recipe. I hope today you have experienced the excitement of baking for yourself first hand, and that you have many joyful experiences in your own kitchen, baking sumptuous delights.

Happy baking.

Matthew Jones
Founder of Bread Ahead
Bakery and School

CINNAMON STRUDEL BABKAS

INGREDIENTS

DOUGH

450g strong white
bread flour
4g fine sea salt
10g caster sugar
5g ground
nutmeg
280g milk
50g butter
20g fresh yeast
(or 10g if dried)

FILLING

20g cinnamon
100g sugar
100g butter

STRUDEL

50g flour
50g sugar
30g butter
Jam (optional)

MAKES 12

METHOD

Place the flour, salt, sugar and nutmeg in a bowl and combine. Then rub the butter into the mix.

Measure out your milk, add the yeast, then mix until dissolved (if using instant/quick/fast-acting dried yeast, mix the yeast through the dry mixture instead).

Make a well in the centre of the flour mixture and pour in the liquid. Gently bring the dough together using a scraper.

Once the dough starts coming together, take it out of the bowl and place it on your work surface. Don't add any flour.

With the heel of your hand, push the dough into the table and using the scraper, fold the dough on itself and repeat, knead for 6-8 minutes. Your dough will become nice and elasticated and have a velvety feel.

Form your dough into a round ball and place it back in the bowl, then cover and leave at room temperature for one hour.

In a small bowl, mix the cinnamon and sugar together, for the filling then mix in the butter until combined.

Roll the dough out to form a 45cm square dough, then cover with the filling, leaving a small strip clear of filling along the bottom edge (this will need to adhere to the dough once it's rolled).

Roll the dough towards you, turning into a log, gently pressing the filling-free edge into the dough to seal it.

Line a tray with baking paper, then cut the roll into 12 pieces and place cut side up on the tray.

For the strudel, in a small bowl, mix the flour and sugar together, then crumb in the butter.

Make an indent in the centre of each babka and fill with a teaspoon of jam, then sprinkle the strudel topping over the top.

Leave to rise at room temperature for 40 minutes.

Preheat your oven to 220°C/200°C fan/gas 7.

Place your tray in the oven and lightly spritz the oven chamber with a water spray. Bake for 20 minutes, then take out of the oven, cool and enjoy.

SOURDOUGH STARTER

INGREDIENTS

50g rye flour
50g cold water

METHOD

DAY 1

Mix the flour and water together. Cover and leave at room temperature for 24 hours.

DAY 2, 3, 4 & 5

Each day, add 50g flour and 50g water to your existing starter, and mix.

By day six it should be nice and lively with some bubbling and a slightly alcoholic aroma.

Following this, store in the fridge in an airtight container and use at least once a fortnight.

Before use, feed with equal amounts of rye flour and water (whatever volumes your recipe requires) and leave at room temperature for eight hours.

BORODINSKY RYE LOAF

INGREDIENTS

DAY 1 - (preferment)

75g rye starter

140g cold water

100g rye flour

DAY 2

Pre-ferment (as above)

175g rye flour

6g fine sea salt

10g caraway seeds

10g coriander seeds

1 tsp molasses

130g cold water

METHOD

Feed your starter a good eight hours before you make this so it is nice and lively.

DAY 1

Mix the starter and water together in a bowl.

Add the flour and bring together to form a nice loose mixture.

Cover and leave at room temperature for 12-24 hours.

DAY 2

Uncover your pre-ferment. It should have lots of air bubbles in it and have a pleasant, slightly alcoholic aroma.

Add all of the ingredients to the bowl with the pre-ferment.

With your hand like a giant fork, bring the mixture together and continue mixing for a good two minutes until fully combined.

Lightly oil a 1lb loaf tin or line with baking paper.

Place your dough into the prepared tin and heavily dust the top of it with more rye flour.

Leave to rise for 2-3 hours (the flour on the surface of the bread will start to crack when it's ready).

Preheat the oven to 230°C/ 210°C fan/ gas 8, then place your bread in the oven and spritz all around the oven chamber with a water spray.

Bake for 40 minutes turning once.

Take the bread out of the oven and tip it out of the tin.

Allow to cool for a good two hours before you slice and eat.